Activity A4 - Set Environmental Objectives and Build Competence

Course: Fundamentals of ISO 14001 Environmental Management System (EMS) (TGS-2023037592) Ability: A6 Objective: Translate priority aspects into measurable objectives, action plans and role-based competence evidence. Mode: Team analysis with individual evidence submission Suggested time: 60 minutes

Scenario

MEP's policy promises resource efficiency and pollution prevention, but targets have no baseline, owners or response thresholds. Annual awareness slides are delivered without checking competence.

Meridian EcoPack Pte Ltd (MEP) is a fictional Singapore SME with 120 employees producing printed corrugated and fibre-based packaging for regional food, electronics and healthcare customers. Two key customers require evidence of an ISO 14001:2026-aligned EMS and stronger value-chain environmental controls before contract renewal.

Task and expected output

Create an electricity/waste objective set and a competence plan for operators, supervisors, contractors and emergency roles.

Produce: A SMART objective/KPI plan, action register, role-competence matrix and evaluation design.

Before you begin

- Open a working copy of the Excel workbook; do not overwrite the supplied evidence.
- Allocate a facilitator, evidence recorder, checker and presenter.
- Read every evidence card before making a compliance or significance conclusion.
- If the activity concerns an incident, this is a tabletop exercise: do not handle chemicals or simulate unsafe physical actions.

Decision questions

1. Which indicators measure environmental performance, implementation progress and control effectiveness?
2. What resources, responsibilities, dates and evaluation methods make the objective executable?
3. What must each role be able to do, and what evidence shows competence rather than attendance?

Detailed procedure

Step 1 - Select two significant aspects and define the intended environmental result, baseline and data boundary

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 2 - Write measurable objectives with targets, dates, owners and assumptions

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Step 3 - Define KPI formula, unit, source, frequency, data-quality control and action threshold

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Step 4 - Build an action plan covering controls, resources, responsibilities, milestones and evaluation of results

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Step 5 - Map critical EMS tasks to role-specific competence and awareness needs, including contractors

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Step 6 - Choose evaluation evidence such as observation, drill performance, work sample or knowledge demonstration and set review dates

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Evidence to submit

- Completed Activity-A4-Workbook.xlsx.
- One evidence-backed team decision and one documented peer challenge.
- Any assumption or missing source clearly labelled for follow-up.

Acceptance checklist

[ ] Each objective links to policy and a priority aspect; KPIs are reproducible and decision-ready; every critical role has competence criteria, evidence method, owner and review date.

[ ] Claims are traceable to supplied or cited evidence.

[ ] Assumptions, uncertainty and missing evidence are labelled.

[ ] Owners, due dates and next decisions are included where applicable.

[ ] Legal/compliance interpretations needing competent advice are escalated rather than guessed.

[ ] A peer challenge and response are recorded.

Troubleshooting

- The team cannot agree on a score: return to the criterion anchors and record each evidence-based assumption before averaging or escalating.
- Evidence is missing: do not invent it; record an evidence gap, risk implication, owner and retrieval action.
- A legal requirement is unclear: record the current authoritative source and escalate to a competent adviser or authority channel.
- A conclusion feels obvious: test an alternative explanation and state what evidence would falsify the current view.

Facilitator debrief

Ask each team to defend one priority, control or conclusion using objective evidence. Probe what would change the decision, then connect the work to PDCA and the relevant EMS process rather than clause memorisation.

Files in this activity pack

- README.md and README.pdf - detailed learner procedure.
- Activity-A4-Scenario-and-Checklist.pdf - printable scenario and completion checklist.
- Activity-A4-Workbook.xlsx - editable analysis and submission workbook.

Source and usage note

This fictional training activity paraphrases ISO 14001 concepts and is not legal advice or a reproduction of the standard. Use the organisation's licensed ISO 14001:2026 copy and current authoritative Singapore sources for formal interpretation.